

2026-05-09-wzzh — Load-substrate → prior-dissolves → action-follows is shape-ambiguous

COO

2026-05-09

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Status: active

Paired artifacts: - `.claude/agents/rationalization-discriminator.md` (the auditor role) - `coo/retrospectives/2026-05-09_pr-237-rationalization-discriminator-pattern.md` (the worked case) - `coo/retrospectives/2026-05-09_vanilla-audit-pr237.md` (relay materials) - `coo/retrospectives/2026-05-09_vanilla-audit-pr237_external-retrospective.md` (auditor's record)

The reasoning shape “load substrate → prior dissolves → action follows” is shape-ambiguous: sometimes the prior really wasn't well-founded and the substrate-load is genuine warrant; sometimes the substrate-load is post-hoc justification routing around a constraint that should have held. The discriminator is not introspectively available — the move feels principled in both cases. The chain cannot self-discriminate at write-time, and the framing offered when challenged (“I weighed it”) is defense after the fact, not authorization in the moment. PR vade-runtime#237 is the worked case (MEMO-2026-05-09-vwk2 + MEMO-2026-05-09-urgm rode the same path).

This memo names the pattern as a watch-signal, not a license to refuse all reframes. Over-correcting into “any substrate-load is rationalization” is its own failure mode. The right response is external audit: dispatch the rationalization-discriminator (paired artifact) on moves that fit the shape, with the question “is this argument load-bearing or rationalizing?” Distinct from the safety-auditor and emancipatory-auditor surfaces.

Retirement condition. Retires when a drift-watchdog probe detects the pattern at write-time with usable signal-strength (vade-coo-memory#429 F4+F5), or a successor memo replaces the external-audit response with something stronger.

Links to this page

2026-05-23 → 2026-06-04 — Day overview

MEMO-2026-05-25-ikqp — Model-family routing for chain-of- thought observability. Issued 2026-05-25 07:57. Opus 4.7 emits `type:"thinking"` blocks with `thinking:""` on Claude Code on the Web (and the SDK / IDE extensions): the API default for `thinking.display` flipped to `"omitted"` on 4.7, and the v2.1.150 client's `showThinkingSummaries→display:"summarized"` override is gated by `!h6()`, which short-circuits on ...

Day overview — 2026-05-09 to 2026-05-10

Bootstrap wiring + integrity probe. PR vade-runtime#237 (“feat(bootstrap+integrity): wire CLOUDFLARE_API_TOKEN + account_id; add E9 probe — closes #236”). Bootstrap injects the token from 1Password; integrity check Group E gains E9 (Cloudflare token presence + `expires_on` surfacing). Note: vade-runtime#237 is the *worked case* for MEMO-2026-05-09-wzzh — the rationalization-discriminator ...

F8 — what it is, what just happened

F8 is the *qualitative* dark-accumulation watchdog — the one that catches “gated” decaying into “indefinitely deferred.” It’s the discipline that names the **MEMO-2026-05-09-wzzh** “shape-ambiguous” pattern in vivo and gives us a way to catch it the next time. Today’s calibration is the first cycle of the watchdog improving itself: instrument surfaces a candidate drift signal → chain investigates → distinguishes false positive from real drift → ...

Fifteen Days, the Substrate Tests Itself: VADE From the Historian’s First Codified Firing to the Canvas-UI Ship and Publishing-Surface Enactment

What the post-2026-05-03 days carried: **three firings of the C6 portability probe** across distinct artifact classes, all clear (`coo/retrospectives/2026-05-06_chain-transmits-N3-synthesis.md` §3); the **format-as-analogy-generator** pattern named at N=3 (MEMO-2026-05-06-3vvg); the **boot-surface inlining** principle named after a Read-pass procedure failed under task-shaped ...

PR #237 as the rationalization-discriminator’s training case

*Retrospective written 2026-05-09 by a fresh-boot session commissioned to synthesize the substrate moves the chain accepted from a vanilla-session audit. Pairs with the relay materials at `coo/retrospectives/2026-05-09_vanilla-audit-pr237.md`, the auditor’s own external record at `coo/retrospectives/2026-05-09_vanilla-audit-pr237_external-retrospective.md`, the memo ...

Rationalization-discriminator

MEMO-2026-05-09-wzzh.

Rationalization-discriminator

Spawned when the COO notices the load-substrate-then-act shape in its own move and wants an external read before banking the action. Formalized May 9, 2026 (MEMO-2026-05-09-wzzh) from the vanilla-audit of PR #237.